COMPLAINT COMPASS · WHEN THEY ASK “HOW WILL YOU SCALE THIS?”

# Scalability: say it like you’re thinking out loud

About 40 seconds. Don’t read it word for word; the five prompts below are enough.

> “So, the nice thing is the expensive part is already solved. Most complaints never touch the LLM, so cost just grows in a straight line. At ten million complaints a month we’re looking at around four hundred dollars in model calls.
>
> On the infrastructure side, the classifying step doesn’t share any data, so we can just add workers. One worker does roughly fifteen complaints a second. To put that in perspective, all of Indian quick commerce averages maybe two a second, so one business fits on a server or two.
>
> The only tricky bit is the issue list, because two workers could create the same issue twice. So we give each business area its own single writer, and they all run side by side. New customer? New partitions. One area gets slammed? We split it.
>
> Honestly, it’s not built at that scale yet. The first thing we’d do is load-test it.”

## Or remember five prompts and talk

1. **Cost:** straight line, about $400 a month at 10 million complaints.
2. **Classifying:** no shared data, so add workers; about 15 a second each.
3. **Market:** about 2 a second in total, so a server or two per business.
4. **Issue list:** one writer per area; new customer means new partitions, a busy area gets split.
5. **Honesty:** not built at scale yet; load test first.

## Only if they ask for detail

| Volume a month | Average / peak per second | Classifier workers | Partitions | Model cost a month |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1M (one business) | 0.4 / 2 | 2 | 7 | $43 |
| 10M (~10 businesses) | 3.9 / 19 | 2–4 | ~70 | $433 |
| 100M (~100 businesses) | 39 / 193 | 13–16 | ~700 | $4,330 |

Throughput is projected from latencies measured on the live run; model cost is $4.33 per 100,000 (measured) × volume, hosting excluded. Peak assumes 5× average; market volume assumes 2% of 7.8M daily orders.